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DEPARTMENT
RECEIVED
AUG 16 1867
OFFICE.

Despatch No: 46. Series / 1867.

U. S. Flag Ship Hartford, (2d Rate).
Off Sea, Lat: 31.°31' N. Long: 123.°47' E.
June 3d, 1867.

Hon. Gideon Welles.
Secretary of the Navy.
Washington D.C.

Sir.

Referring to my monthly Report of April 30th, 1867, I informed the Department that Commander Jeffers in the Ashuelot, was sent to Formosa, to rescue the surviving Officers and Crew of the American Barque Rover - that had been wrecked to the Southward of that Island: I have now the honor to enclose the Report of Commander Jeffers marked A - received May 25th., of his proceedings, and the result of his investigations; by which it will be seen, that it is probable, that every one except one Chinaman, belonging to the Rover, was murdered by the Savages, living on Formosa.

This

Enclosure.

B. 3.

U. S. Steamer Ashuelot.
Commander's Quarters.
Hong Kong May 30th. 1867.

To.
Wm. Moore Esquire.
U.S. Vice Consul at
Nagasaki.

Sir. U.S.S. Wyoming will leave at 4 P.M. 31st. Inst. for Hong Kong in the Anna Kimball. Requesting him, to send an officer of the U.S. Consulate on board of her, to identify and take charge of the Anna Kimball.

Private affair - Hong

This Island is divided between three different
races of men. The Chinese possess "Kelung" in
the North, Tamsui, Taiwan-fu, Takau —
Liang-kiau, in fact all the west Coast, to within
ten miles of the South end of the Island, in
which direction, they are gradually extending
their Settlements: On the East Coast is
Saw-o, Nazions, the West ow the Island, inhabit-
ed by Chinese of a common order, and some
half breeds of Aboriginals and Chinese, - from
here to the South end of the Island, there are
two or three small villages of the same descrip-
tion of inhabitants, only more wild and Savage,
Wearing Scarcely any Clothing, and are quite as
hostile to foreigners, when good opportunities
occur as their wilder brethren; these bearing the
blame. The Coast is high and rugged.

The pure Aboriginals live in the mountains,
and in the Tented valleys, extending down
to the Coast, as wild as Genies, and not in
villages, nor in huts Even: They are in com-
munication with half-breeds, though not

with

Chinese, who dread them.

Many American and European vessels, have appeared off the South End of Formosa, at various times in hurricanes, and not in hurricanes: It has been long surmised, that some of their unfortunate Crews after having escaped to Formosa, (like that of the Rover,) cruelly perished by the hands of the wild natives and half-breeds, infesting that part of the Coast: This well authenticated treatment of the "Rover's" Crew, confirms that opinion:.

And as there is no Government to deal, with in this matter; I shall proceed at once, with this Ship, and one or two others, to the South End of Formosa, and land Small Arms. enough, to scour the thickets there, and Execute upon whatever ones the wretches may have there: The Department will perceive the difficulty of a Transient force landed from Ships getting at a foe, that live more like monkeys than men.

Feeling this uncertainty, and knowing that the Chinese Officials in the West of the Island, are

Extending

Extending their authority over the Island, I directed Commander Tebiger to induce the Taotai and Chief Officials to take this affair in hand, and possess themselves of the fine Bay on the South End, offering them assistance, and in any event, to go there himself; - But those Officers decline this offer, pretending that they will send an Expedition of their Own, in due time.

I am satisfied, that the barbarities of those Savages, can not be permanently stopped, until the Government at Peking, be induced by the action of the American and other Foreign Ministers, at that Court, to occupy all the Villages and Bays on the East Coast, and on the South, and thus drive the Aboriginals back to the Interior of the Island. They are a cruel pest to all Mariners, who may be so unfortunate, as to be thrown On their Coast. And there is no known way of dealing with them as a Community.

I have the Honour to be, Sir.
Very Respectfully.
Your Obedient Servant
H H Bell
Rear Admiral Commdg U.S. Asiatic Squadron

DEPARTMENT
RECEIVED
AUG 16 1867
C. OFFICE.

U. S. S. "Schuylkill" 3d Rate
Amoy China
April 26. 1867.

Sir.

I have the honor to report that in obedience to your Order dated the 5th Instant I left Foo Chow in the Morning of the 11th arriving at Tam-Sui the following Morning When I received your letter dated the 11th directing me not to burn the Town at the Place when the Murder of the "Rover" Crew occurred, and Expressing your desire that the Chinese Authorities should take the initiative in the case. Having visited and received return visits from the Principal Officials of Tam Sui, We left on the 15th for Sai-Wan-Foo Anchoring off Makong Harbor Pescadores and arriving off Tai-wan-Foo the Morning of the 18th Immediately forwarded a letter to the Three Principal

Henry A. Bell
Rear Admiral
Commd'g U.S. Asiatic Sqn.
Flt Sqn. off Amoy 31.31 N.
Long: 123.47 E.

Sir,

I have the honor to enclose herewith for the information of the Department, a Report of the Proceedings of the Boat Expedition sent from this Ship on the 3d Instant to the Island of Formosa, for the purpose of obtaining information relative to the Murder of the Crew of the American Schooner "Rover" which was plundered and burned by the Savages on the East Coast of the Island of Formosa.

II. A Proposal to Land Small Armed Force when to Storm Stockaded Village.

Respectfully
Your Obt. Servt.
[illegible]
Commanding U.S.S. Schuylkill

Enclosure
Report of Proceedings of Boat Expedition sent from U.S.S. Schuylkill on the 3d Instant to the Island of Formosa.

Authorities of the Island (General Tsalai and Prefect) informing them of the Reported Murder of the Foyer Crew, and requesting that an immediate investigation of the case should be made, that in case, there were any of the Crew still remaining in the Hands of the Savages, that immediate Steps be taken to recover them, that a proper armed Force be sent at once, & that all implicated in the Murder might be seized and punished in accordance with Chinese Law, also offering to assist, and Co-operate with My Command in carrying out these Objects. An answer to my letter was received the following day, stating that information of the Case had been received previous to my arrival, that Steps had been taken to investigate, and that an Armed Force should be sent to bring the perpetrators of the Outrage to punishment.

A Copy of my letter to the authorities and the Original reply with a rough translation are enclosed herewith—

After the receipt of their letter I called upon the General, Taotai, and Prefect, individually, was well received by them all, and afterwards received return visits, from them at at Houses provided for us by the Prefect.

During these interviews I expressed my anxiety as to the possibility of some of the Crew of the Rover being still alive in the Hands of the savages, their reply was, that they had reliable information of their all having shared the same fate; to my request that an armed Force should be immediately sent and that my assistance accepted. their reply was that the Country was unknown to them, that proper persons had been sent to gain information, after the reception of which, a Force would be dispatched immediately to.

make thorough work of it, and that my
offered assistance would not be required.

The General in Command, appears
to be an energetic, active Man, and
is of higher Rank, than the other
Authorities. He has, it is stated about
six thousand Troops under his
Orders, who are well armed, and
drilled. From his remarks during
our interview, I am of the opinion
that he is desirous of making such
thorough work in this case as to
derive Credit from the Government at
Pekin. —

Leaving the anchorage off
Saimaw Fort on the 21st we anchored
the same afternoon off the Port of
Takow. Here I received a Note from
Mr. Carroll, the English Consul, offering
any information in his possession, and
expressing a desire to accompany us. —
His Note and a Copy of my reply
is enclosed. — There being no

further information to be obtained
here, we left on the 22nd anchoring
the same day in Leang Kiaou Bay.
this Place is only seen for a Twelve
Miles distant from the scene of the
Murder, and Entertained Hopes of
receiving further and reliable
intelligence, but was disappointed
I visited the village, and had Commu-
nication with the Head Man, who Could
not, or would not give any information
other than we already possessed. All
My endeavour to procure a Messenger
to the Savages was met with, the
assertion that any one going would
lose his life. the opinion was
general that all the Loo Choo
men Killed. still I offered Rewards
to any one who would rescue the
seamen if any, or produce reliable
intelligence as to their fate.

Leaving this Bay early on the
Morning of the 24th I arrived in a

few Trees at the place where the Murder
was committed. Here at the Head of the
Bay we found a Chinese Boat at
anchor, loaded with wood, and with
a crew of four Men, Imagine these
Men on board they were interrogated
singly. The result of which was,
that they were from Tai wan foo,
had been there eight days, detained
five of them by the fresh N.E wind that
was then blowing, that they had not
been on Shore, that the wood was
brought off to them in Bamboo
Rafts, that they had made arrangements
to receive it, Upon arrival, with a
Man named Mori, residing on the
West Coast. that the Inhabitants of the
few Huts visible from the Ship at
the Head of the Bay were Half
Breeds, that the Savages lived on
the other side of the Hills, did not
know if they have a village, that a
Chinese Boat often Come here for

Mod- Knew that the Savages had
Killed some Shangus, but not how
many- I endeavoured to get one
of these men to go on Shore, and
enter into Communication with the
Half Breeds, in the Hopes of procuring
a Messenger to the Savages promising
reward and Threats were alike
useless, they asserting that the Half
Breeds were as bad as the Savages
and would certainly kill them if
they went ashore- The
Rowes Boat spoken of by Commander
Read of the "Comorant" as being on
the Beach has disappeared- Upon
our arrival and during our Stay,
the Savages occasionally made their
appearance on the Hills several
Miles distant- Near our Anchorage-
(Which was at the Head of the Bay)
there were Three or Four small Huts
the Inhabitants of which occasionally
appeared, and seemed to be the

Half Breeds, Spoken of, by their
Chiefs (which was partially
Chinese).

The Hills and Shores of
the Bays, then being covered with
one Mell wooded, with a thick
undergrowth running down close
to the water. I consider it
impossible to fire it, in its
present Green State, and with
the fresh S.E. wind blowing
during our Stay — By
Shelling the underbrush well,
a landing could be effected with-
out loss, but in my opinion
a Force of at least 150 or 200
Men would be required to advance
any distance beyond the Crest of
the Hills.

I enclose a Sketch (by Dr.
Manson of Takow) of the Bay in
which the Murder of the 1st
Boat Crew took place, which

Will give yor an idea of the locality

Getting underweigh on the evening of the 24th We arrived here on the Morning of the 26th

Genl Le Gendre the Consul of Amoy accompanied me during the Cruise, and Communicated with the Authorities in relation to the case of the Rover Crew

Very Respectfully
Yours &c Stewart
Jno. C. Howell
Commander

Rear Admiral
H H Bell
Commanding Asiatic Squadron
U.S. Flag Ship "Hartford"
Shanghai China

Lieut C. Hagei. Commdg
U.S.S. Schuylkill
Copy April 26th 1867
Reporting arrival at
Formosa —
A Despatch No 46

Received at Yokohama
May 2nd 1867 at 9 P.M.

U. S. S. "Schuylkill" 3d Rate
off Tai-Wan-foo Formosa
April 17. 1867.

Sir

I have the honor to inform you that the American Barque "Rover" on the 12th of March 1867. ran upon a Rock on the Southern Coast of Formosa Island, and was so much injured, that to save their lives the crew were forced to take to the Boats. The Captain, his wife, 2nd Mate and three (3) Seamen went in one Boat and landed inside the S. W. Point of the Island about Fifty (50) Miles to the Southard of Takao, where they are reported to have been murdered, with the exception of one Seamen who escaped. The other Boat with the Chief Mate and Seven (7) Seamen are supposed to have landed near the same place, and to have met the same fate. As soon as this intelligence was

received by Rear Admiral H. H. Bell
Commanding the Naval Forces of the
United States in the China Seas
He directed me to communicate
with You, and request that an
immediate investigation should
be made of the case, and if any
of the Crew of the "Rover" now still
alive in the hands of the Natives,
that they be immediately recovered,
and delivered over into the hands
of the American Authorities; also that
all persons implicated in this
outrage be seized and punished
in accordance with Your Laws.

Admiral H. H. Bell Esquire
that upon the receipt of this
Communication You will immediately
Order a proper armed Force
to Search and Seize all implic-
cated for punishment; Should
You desire assistance, I hereby
proffer all that is in the power
of My Command

The American Consul of Amoy
China Genl Le Gendre accompanies
me and will address ya a
communication on the subject.
Hoping for an immediate
and favorable reply I have the
honor to remain

Very Respectfully
Your obt Servant
Jno. C. Febiger
Commander
U. S. Navy.

Their Honors
The Taotai, Prefect and Genral
of Tai wan foo
Formosa.

DEPARTMENT
RECEIVED
AUG 26 1967
RECORDS

254

Copy

The Day- 3d Moon- 6th Year.

Dear Sir

I beg to reply to You-
On the 14th Day of the 3d Moon me
received Your letter, stating a Copy of
My letter addressed to the Authorities of
Tai-Wan-foo)

We are investigating this
case which is now on foot
The Tsotai says) On the 18th Day 2nd Moon
6th Year, I have received a letter from Consul
Carroll, stating:-

"I beg to inform You that on the 5th
day of this Moon, an English vessel sailing
on the Leang-Kiew Sea, near the Red Head
Island struck on a Rock and the Crew
thirteen (13) in number took to their Boat
to save their lives, they went to the Leang-
Kiew Bay, at a place known as "Kowai cas-
pis-no"- At this point the Savages like
to kill as one likes to eat- those fourteen
men escaping from the Tigers Mouth fell
into the Snare- Thirteen men killed one
escaping went to a village called Pia-a-liang
on the San-Chia-Shiang road, where the
Head man and Inhabitant furnished him a
passage in a Cargo Boat to My Consulate

A.L. Redfield No 45

Received at Nagasaki
May 25th 1867 P.M.

Takow. — The [illegible] of [illegible] Thirteen
[illegible] cries for vengance. — I have found that
[illegible] Mau Chas told me the truth. I shall
[illegible] this case to my superiors, and wish
[illegible] to give orders to your authorities to
[illegible] out all the truths, and also to punish
[illegible] Guilty parties, according to your Laws
[illegible] Order to prevent any similar occurrence
[illegible] the future."

With many thanks &c &c.

15th day 2nd Moon

Name on the Cards

Recd 18th Da. of 2nd Moon

On receipt of this letter I ordered
the Chief Magistrate of Tor-Chee Ching to
communicate without delay with the
Military Officer of the District to make an
investigation and report to me. — I also
requested that Officer to issue a Proclamation
forbidding Chinese or Foreigners against
unlawfully going into the Territory of the
Aborigines there being danger of their losing
their lives by doing so. — This Officer
reported to me that on the 29th Ult he placed
himself in Communication with the Military
Officer of the District (Col. Lind) they both
proceeded to Takow and had an interview with
Consul Carroll and Commissioner of Customs.

[illegible] those Gentleman described the
Savages as living like Animals, and as
being incapable of holding any Negotiations
with Civilized people — That Place is
thickly Wooded, and the Savages hide themselves
in the Trees, and are in a perfectly Wild
State — that it would be difficult to employ
an armed Force against them. — After
that, I received a letter from Consul Carroll
stating his gratitude, as a Copy herein
enclosed, shows. (This letter refers to another
matter).

I beg to inform you that on the 23d.
day of this Moon I received yours of the 20th —
I understand all — I have a letter from
the Captain stating, that when She grounded
on the West Coast You sent a Force to
protect him — The vessel is now safe
and has gone to Amoy — I write this
to you, to thank You for your Kindness —

27th Day 5th Moon.

Name on the Card

Rec'd 2nd Day 3d Moon.

(This letter is in reference to a vessel
that grounded to the Northard of Tai-wan-foo")

(The Gen'l Footai and Prefect

of Pescaris that shew the intelligence of

遵循此事
辉次江陵当冲碰撞碎船中彩计共十只为小杉板
此生无张瑞庆等船用桑山各岸据料张永生看见
人喝救一时浪船判院虎口之生非此刀下之死者
被捉救十三人被在一人此主张七无药仍投庆事例办
乃禀
贵辕张瑞庆等禀在铺尸将船戴一名范记货船来
顾玉献署收投甘日伏思该船载十三名二等受来
宪验饬伸前项此事一人采伤实情理合投明特行
伴伏祈
贵宪核饬该委把有官虚张情形一面出伴先行知以
便传集讯明咸饬押伸施行
须至禀者
文登不宜
名另具 首十四日
要禀 月十八日

对台批单A廿日该船
今自备钱一切附水
清点咸俱当族无异
甘结是实
实习运户人摇船无所藉
原恳咸美结言到日将帆屋内夫仰如
同出具结附卷
须至结者
名下具 首甘结
要禀 首甘二日

the Murder of the Rogers Crew reached
us, an order was immediately given,
before You arrived, to have the Matter
investigated by our Authorities— But those
Savages are like animals living in
the Mountains and Woods, that it is
difficult to employ an armed Force
against them, Upon this the English
Consul and other Officers agree Formosa
Savages live like Monkeys in the Rocks,
this Territory is not in our Maps, they do
not obey our Laws. We have issued a
Proclomation warning any of our Persons
taking any animals into their Territory
for Sale— We have placed Guard-gates
over Gate to protect people from their
hostility— When that vessel was
wrecked and the Crew went into the
Country of the Savages, it was a Fatality
for the one could help them.

If it is in our Power to find Means
to punish those men we shall not refuse
to do so; in order to keep peace with Foreign
Nations— There is no necessity for you to
trouble Yourselves to punish those by us
the Mischiefs this case, if any one of you
should happen to be hurt no Steamer for

uncomfortable.

Now we are going to give
notice to the Civil and Military Officers
to send a body of Troops to manage
this case — For. say You wish to
help us with Your Man-of-War, We beg
You not to do so, In the mild You
this reply, and Enclose Mr. Edkins
Consular Letter.
Vice-Consul of Tamsui, and Prefect (Officers)
Tai-Wan-Foo Formosa—

STATE DEPARTMENT
RECEIVED
AUG 16 1867
DIPLOMATIC BUREAU

Consulate 261

Tamsui 25 April 67

To Commander of
the U.S.S. Ashuelot

Sir

I have been compelled to proceed to Taiwanfoo on public business, but- trust to find you here on my return, which will be on Tuesday or Wednesday- I leave the matter in charge of the Consulate.- he will be happy to render you any assistance or information you may require -

I

Respectfully &c &c
Thayer
U.S. Consul

Tamsui April 25th 1867

U.S.S. Ashuelot
Off Tamsui

Army Officers

April 25, 1867.

A-2. Despatch No 46-

Received at Nagasaki
May 21st 1867
Off Pile

I am very anxious to accompany you on y
Expedition against the savages in the So
and think that my presence might be
useful to you, from the fact of my hav
been on the Spot before -

I am Sir
Your faithfully
Charleswell

Encl. Chas Carroll Esq.
H.B.M. Consul
Takow Formosa
Read and answered
April 25 1867 Takow Fm

A - 3 - Despatch No 6

Received at Legation
May 25th 1867 Peking

Ship DEPARTMENT OF STATE AUG 16 1867 SEC. OFFICE

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U. S. S. "Ashuelot"
Off Takow. Formosa
April 25th 1867.

Sir.

Your Note of yesterday with its kind offer of assistance or information was received upon my arrival - I regret that I have not the time at my disposal to remain until after your return, as I am desirous of personally expressing my obligations for the exertions you have already made in behalf of the unfortunate Crew of the "Rover"

The punishment of all implicated in the Murder is for the present in the hands of the Chinese Authorities, and my visit to the place will only be for the purpose of gaining information, were it otherwise, your kind offer to accompany me would be accepted with thanks, and would doubtlessly be of great value.

Very Respectfully
Your Ob. Servant
Jno. C. Febiger.
Commdr

H.B.M. Consul
Chas. Carroll Esq.
Takow. Formosa.

Copy of letter in answer to Mr. Secretary Welles's letter of Jan. 21st 1867

U. S. Steamer "Hartford"
April 22nd 1867

A-4-Despatch No 46

Remarks as to Appointments
May 25th 1867-6 Pm

NAVY DEPARTMENT
RECEIVED
AUG 16 1867
SEC. OF NAVY

No: 47. Series of 1867:

U. S. Flag Ship Hartford (2d Rate).
Shanghai, China.
June 5th 1867.

Hon. Gideon Welles
Secretary of the Navy
Washington: D.C.

Sir.

I have the honour to acknowledge the reception of the Department's Communications of January 21st, 1867. and February 27th. 1867. By both of which, I am informed of the Reception by the Department of the Record of the proceedings of sundry Naval General Courts Martial, held in the Squadron under my Command, and that "the Proceedings findings and sentences with your (my) "action upon them are respectively Approved".

I have to note the Department's instructions, in this Connection, relative to the organization of Naval General Courts Martial, namely "to appoint no Officer as a member, whose "Commission